The Noble Sūtra of Mahālakṣmī

Āryamahālakṣmīsūtra · Toh 1005 · Derge Kangyur
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The Noble Sūtra of Mahālakṣmī, known in Sanskrit as the Āryamahālakṣmīsūtra and in Tibetan as Pakpa Pal Chenmö Do, is a brief scripture centered on the goddess of fortune and prosperity, Mahālakṣmī. Set in the pure land of Sukhāvatī, it opens as the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara approaches the Blessed One. The Buddha then turns his attention toward Mahālakṣmī and declares that anyone who knows her twelve names will cast off poverty and become wealthy, whether a monk, nun, layman, laywoman, or anyone else. The same blessing extends to those who hold, read, write, or have the names written. The text is Toh 1005 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the short dhāraṇī-style works that pair a sacred formula or list of names with promised benefits for those who recite and preserve it.

In the language of India: ārya mahālakṣīṇī sūtra
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Sūtra of Mahālakṣmī

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in Sukhāvatī. Then the bodhisattva, the great being, noble Avalokiteśvara, went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and sat down to one side.

Then the Blessed One looked toward Mahālakṣmī and spoke these words to noble Avalokiteśvara: "Whoever knows these twelve names of Mahālakṣmī, whether a monk, a nun, a layman, a laywoman, or anyone else at all, and whoever holds them, reads them, writes them, or has them written, will cast off poverty and become wealthy."

Then all the hosts of bhūtas entreated with one voice, "May it be so!"

Then the Blessed One spoke the twelve names of Mahālakṣmī, as follows: the Glorious One, the Auspicious One, She Who Wears a Lotus Garland, Mistress of Wealth, the White One, She of Great Renown, the Lotus-Eyed One, the Maker, She of Great Radiance, Giver of Food, Lavish Giver of Jewels, and Mahālakṣmī.

syādyathedanā jini ghrini sarva artha sādhani śaśini alakṣmini menāśaya siddhyantu mantra padāḥ svāhā

oṃ bhṛkuṭī parama subhage svāhā

This should be recited three times. Whoever recites it at the three times of day will see all adverse forces destroyed. They will come to possess good fortune. Their wealth will become inexhaustible. When going to meet someone, if one reads it before the meeting, that person will come to regard one as a son, will be delighted, and will do whatever one bids. If one reads it constantly and without interruption, then even if Brahmā and brahmins perform violent rites against one, they will not prevail, and one will also have honored and served many buddhas.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva noble Avalokiteśvara rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the Noble Sūtra of Mahālakṣmī.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Jinamitra and the chief editor and translator Bandé Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The setting is given as Sukhāvatī, as the Tibetan states. The twelve names are rendered by their meanings as epithets of the goddess. The last name is her own name, Mahālakṣmī. "Brahmā and brahmins" could also be read as "brahmins of Brahmā's class."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.